

SUPREME COURT

Affirms Decision Against the Two Anarchists.

Other Important Cases.—Constitutionality of the McKinley Act.—The "New Government" Case.

Special to the Inquirer.

Washington, Feb. 29.—In the case of the anarchists, Golden and Schuch, serving life terms in the Joliet, Ill., penitentiary, for participation in the Haymarket riots, the Supreme Court affirmed the decision of the Supreme Court of Illinois that their sentence was not in violation of the constitution.

Three cases in which importers sought to test the constitutionality of the McKinley tariff act, were today decided by the Supreme Court, which affirmed the judgments of the Supreme Court of Illinois in favor of the constitutionality of the act.

The "quorum" case in which the legality of the Dingley wares law was made up by the Supreme Court was also decided by the Supreme Court. The Dingley act was passed through the action of Speaker Reed in counting a quorum when the act was made up by the majority present but not voting. The importers maintained that Speaker Reed's action was in violation of the constitution and that the act passed in this manner was void. The Court in a 5-4 opinion, which Chief Justice holds the "no quorum" rule valid, held that the Speaker's action was not a violation of the constitution.

CONGRESSIONAL

HOUSE.

Washington, Feb. 29.—The House committee reported a resolution that Speaker Reed should be censured for March 22nd, 23rd and 24th, and Catechings has given notice that he will bring up the resolution next Monday.

SINCE STREET CAR STRIKES.

Indianapolis, Ind. Feb. 29.—There is a strike of the street car drivers in Indianapolis. Five hundred special policemen have been sworn in to move their cars under their protection. The streets are crowded with cars, and at a little after 1 o'clock this morning 2000 people were crowded on special policemen and badly hurt them.

WHISKY TRUST OFFICIAL INDICTED.

Chicago, Feb. 29.—It is definitely known that the Federal grand jury at Washington on Feb. 11th indicted all the leading directors of the Whiskey Trust for a violation of the Sherman anti-trust law. Today United States' deputies are engaged in serving warrants for the arrest of the indicted men.

A BIG STRIKE ANTICIPATED.

London, Feb. 29.—It is now estimated that 200,000 men in Great Britain are in a fortnight in their efforts to prevent a reduction in wages. If the strike is successful, a strike in industry will be adversely affected, and it is estimated that a million men will be affected.

COMMERCIAL TREATY WITH FRANCE.

Paris, Feb. 29.—Whitehall, Rome, London, Berlin and Vienna are all in a state of excitement over the commercial treaty between France and the United States.

VALPARAISO, FEB. 29.—CHILE HAS

bought new warships and fort guns for the Chilean navy. The United States government has instructed Genoa to send him the same as he has ordered.

LOS ANGELES.

Los Angeles, Feb. 29.—In the prize fighting and providing for a fine of from five hundred to one thousand dollars for participating in or assisting in such fights.

CHILDREN HURDLED TO DEATH.

Seattle, Feb. 29.—Three children perished in a fire that destroyed the residence of James Simpson, early this morning. Simpson made no effort at fire-fighting to save the children.

BERLIN QUIET.

Berlin, Feb. 29.—Noun.—Since Saturday night the city has been quiet. There have been no disturbances that called for armed police intervention.

CHRISTIAN, FEB. 29.—THE FINAL

results of the world's skating championship, between Skater and Victor for the latter.

WASHINGTON, FEB. 29.—SENATOR

Sherman will not resign.

NEW YORK, FEB. 29.—IT IS STATED

that Gould left this afternoon for the West.

A QUAKE.

The Dalles, Feb. 29.—Three shocks of earthquake were felt this morning.

MARKETS.

San Francisco, Feb. 29.—Wheat, buyers scarce. \$1.77.

THE NATIONAL HISTORY SOCIETY.

The National History Society is holding its annual meeting on Saturday in their rooms opposite the Public Library.

A DYNAMITE PLOT.

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THE LOST WOMAN.

A Grossly Erroneous Version of the Story.

Joaquin Miller Writes History to Suit Himself - The Location of the Channel Islands - That "Castle."

The story of the Indian woman who lived for eighteen years alone on San Nicolas island has been written of frequently and by some of our best-writers, Mrs. Helen Hunt Jackson thought the theme worthy an article from her pen, and Mrs. Lucy A. Brinkerhoff furnished a readable and well-written sketch. Hardly a newspaper in the state has lacked one or more articles concerning the lone dweller on the faraway island. Indeed the subject has been written up so many times that I supposed everyone must be acquainted with the salient points of the story. In this, however, I was mistaken for even now comes the Cincinnati Times-Star with an account of the story written by no less a person than Joaquin Miller, the long-haired poet of the Sierras. To a person unfamiliar with the truth concerning the lost woman, Mr. Miller's sketch would be found very romantic and interesting, but to people who are in possession of the truth smacks too strongly of the novelist for it is grossly erroneous in almost every part. Probably Mr. Miller has become so habituated to the use of the well-known poetic license that he finds it impossible to restrain his pen to the straight and narrow path of truth.

I do not purpose to inflict the whole known history of the remarkable woman upon my readers. I

able woman upon my readers. I simply wish to note some of the grossest errors fallen into by Mr. Miller, and perhaps show that the people living on this coast are not the hard-hearted race he would make them out.

First, I wish to call attention to the error Mr. Miller makes in regard to the location of San Nicolas island. He says it is only twenty miles from Santa Barbara. To people who live here this statement is preposterous. Santa Cruz is the nearest land off shore from Santa Barbara and by a straight line that is twenty-five miles distant. But the woman lived on San Nicolas island, which is still more distant. By reference to the chart issued by the U. S. Coast and Geodetic Survey we find San Nicolas is forty-nine miles from Santa Cruz, and that by a straight line drawn from Santa Barbara to San Nicolas the distance is seventy-seven and one-half miles. But to draw this line we must pass over the great island of Santa Cruz.

Mr. Miller says the steamer Winfield Scott was wrecked on a still smaller island than San Nicolas, not far away. This is an error also. The steamer was wrecked on the middle Anacapa, distant forty-nine miles from San Nicolas. Wouldn't a person need a wonderful pair of eyes and a powerful glass to enable an object no larger than a woman to be seen forty-nine miles away? Yet Mr. Miller says: "The wreckers and others saw the woman many frequently."

Prof. George Davidson, of the U. S. Coast and Geodetic Survey, in commenting on the voyage of Cabrillo through the Santa Barbara Channel and speaking of the Santa Barbara island (which lies between the mainland and San Nicolas) says: "Supposing he (Cabrillo) sailed from the north harbor of Santa Catalina island to the throat of the Santa

island to the throat of the Santa Barbara channel reckoned as lying between Anacapa island and Point Huemul; he passed not nearer than fifteen miles to Santa Barbara island and forty-two miles to San Nicolas island. The former (Santa Barbara) is visible in clear weather with a sharp lookout; the latter (San Nicolas) is not visible unless by extraordinary refraction."

What did Mr. Miller mean when he used this expression, "and so the long, black and barren mountains of and away to the south was as inaccessible to them as the moon is to us." There is no land south of San Nicolas island. The vast, the boundless waste of the Pacific ocean only is seen or found.

He says: "They had queer little houses of stone on the one low cliff." This assertion will be a genuine surprise to any one who has made a study of the island aborigines. The fact is, ordinarily their dwellings were mean shelters made of brush and their most pretentious buildings were made by thrusting the ribs of stranded whales into the ground around a circle; the upper ends brought together to a peak, and the whole covered with the skins of seals and similar animals, the seams being sewed together with sinews.

Mr. Miller draws a very pathetic picture of the lone woman standing on a pyramid of heaped-up stones watching the ships pass by. He tells how she spent years in building her little fortress, "and she built it with all the care and skill of a trained engineer." This and the little tower she had built on top, "where she would at last lie down and die."

she put him on top, "where she could at last lie down and die," make a mighty pretty little edifice, and we actually hesitate ere we lay our vandal hands on it and topple it over. But we must. The cool, calm, unaffected, unromantic fact is, that it is all arrant lish—the most unmitigated sentimental rot—good for fiction, but mighty mean for fact. The woman built no castle at all. She accepted her lot and was contented to industriously accumulate provisions without wasting her time in posing as a feathered biped on a pile of rocks.

Now, one word as to why the woman was not rescued sooner. The island on which she lived is a good ways from Santa Barbara. It is a difficult place on which to land—there is only one place where it can be done in safety—and the prevalence of heavy gales of wind in many months of the year prevents most people from ever visiting it, yet many attempts were made, though it was not certain the woman was alive. Mr. Miller affirms that the ocean at San Nicolas is smooth and the landing easy. This is all guess work on his part, and I do not believe he ever was on the island at all. He probably mistook it for Anacapa.

I will close this article by quoting from the statement of John Nidaver, who commanded the party that rescued her. There were four Mission Indians, Charles Brown and an Irishman in the company (nary a Boston bean soter in the lot, though Miller says the woman was rescued by two Boston men).

They were found and landed on the island and covered the ground

within the enclosure, and which no doubt served as a bed. * * *

Within the enclosure—made of whale ribs, covered with brush—was a smouldering fire, and without a large pile of ashes and another of bones, which would indicate that this had been her abode for a long time. To the surprise of Brown, the woman received him with much dignity and politeness, bowing and smiling with ease and self-possession. As fast as the men came up she greeted them in the same way. The men seated themselves on the ground around, the woman all the while talking, (womanlike) although not a word of hers could be understood, although one Indian spoke several dialects. From a sack or bag made of grass she took some roots, known among the Californians as the "carcomites," and another root whose name I did not learn, and placed them in the fire. When they were roasted she offered them to us to eat. We were now desirous of taking her on board the schooner. We commenced by making signs for her to go with us, but she seemed unable to comprehend them till we intimated that she must gather up all her food, when she set about the work with the greatest alacrity." After she arrived in Santa Barbara Mr. Nidver took her to his home where she lived from that time on. Capt. Henry Carnes saw the woman and describes her as being rather small, with weather-beaten dark skin.

LORENZO G. YATES.